

5 Affordable Housing Policies

Affordable housing is a critical issue to **Richmond** residents because housing is a fundamental human need. When this need is not met, community members experience a decline in equity (1) and health (2). Affordable housing policies aim to reduce these harms and improve the lives of residents.



1

Density Bonuses

Density bonuses permit builders to construct higher density housing if they include a certain number of affordable units (3). This encourages the construction of affordable homes.

2

Expedited Permitting

Expedited Permitting reduces development time for projects supporting affordable housing. This incentivizes affordable housing developments.

3

Fee Waivers or Reductions

Fee waivers or reductions for affordable housing projects can improve housing affordability by reducing construction costs.

4

Zoning Reform

Reforms to zoning that allow higher density housing can reduce housing costs and increase housing affordability.

5

Affordable Housing Trust Fund

Increasing funding to affordable housing trust funds could allow more affordable housing projects to be completed.

References:

1.“Affordable Housing Can Promote Greater Equity” North Carolina Housing Finance Agency
Available:
<https://www.nchfa.com/affordable-housing-can-promote-greater-equity>

2.“Housing Instability” Healthy People 2030, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
Available:
<https://odphp.health.gov/healthypeople/priority-areas/social-determinants-health/literature-summaries/housing-instability>

3.“At a Glance” Development Incentives, Home For All San Mateo County
Available:
<https://homeforallsmc.org/strategies/development-incentives/>